

Smartlabs' HomeKit Hub and the Wink Hub. As of now, Amazon Echo and Google Home are unavailable in India, and their apps aren't available on Indian app stores either, so you'd want to hold off on ordering any of those from outside India.

The functionality of hubs increases manifold when they are integrated with services such as IFTTT (If This Then That), that allow a user to create simple commands in the form of "if this even happens, then that event is triggered". These services might, for example, allow you to trigger an alarm if a sensor on a certain window detects that it is being opened. If we program the setup to switch on the lighting in a room when the door opens or closes, the hub would be the central device that would receive signals from the sensor when any motion is detected, and would correspondingly route that signal to the lighting system, thus switching it on or off.

Many consumers start home automation with the purchase of a smart home hub and add devices to the automation system incrementally. As in the case of many products, such as SmartThings, the hub comes included with a set of other smart devices that are needed to connect compatible devices within the household to the hub.

Activities such as locking the door, shutting off the lights and switching on/off ACs, lamps, electrical devices and such can easily be automated without the help of a hub. But if you intend to branch out your home automation into multiple unconnected devices, using a hub to manage them all will remove your need for multiple apps to support the devices.

More complex and expensive systems such as home monitoring and security are also included in the growing list of home automation systems too, so the hub may also connect to video cameras, door and window sensors, motion sensors and alarms. Choosing a hub can be a complex venture, if you have a multitude of smart devices in your home. Different devices use different protocols for wireless communication between the hub and the connected device, like IR devices or dedicated connections like ZigBee or Z-Wave. Hence,



Samsung SmartThings Hub